

Manohar Achar

PRODUCT DESIGNER • DETROIT, MI

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EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer • Sparks Behavioral Services

MAY 2025 – JAN 2026

cooperantlearning.com • Bloomfield, MI

- Designed and built Cooperant Learning from scratch, a 0-to-1 CEU credentialing platform turning behavioral-health podcast episodes into quiz-based learning for BCBAs, collapsing five disconnected steps into one live web app across six core surfaces.
- Drove a **35% repeat-purchase rate**, **+250% organic-search growth**, and 18 CEU episodes live, leaving the client able to publish new courses without a designer in the loop.
- Validated with a 20-participant moderated BCBA study: **SUS 84.9**, **NPS +65**, platform-trust 4.65/5, and 86% task completion, with every issue rated Minor severity.

Graduate Research Assistant, UX Designer

MAY 2025 – PRESENT

• University of Michigan–Dearborn

- Designed a randomized video-scenario study on L2↔L3 automation mode awareness and trust calibration (N=192; 81% completion), synthesizing findings into 8 UX/HMI recommendations that raised mode-identification accuracy from **69% to 82%**.

Senior Product Design Engineer • Ingersoll Rand Industrial Technologies

JUL 2023 – JUL 2024

Bangalore, India

- Designed the facility-manager-facing fleet layer of a live web platform that runs a whole plant's compressors as one coordinated system; shipped and scaled past the pilot to **~40 facilities**, **~150 assets**, **~200 users**.
- Made plant-wide automation legible enough to trust, driving **~85% time** in coordinated mode, which unlocked **~13% energy reduction** and **~99.4% pressure-up**time through 6 failure events on the pilot line.

Junior Product Design Engineer • Ingersoll Rand Industrial Technologies

JUL 2019 – JUL 2023

- Redefined the home hierarchy of an industrial machine controller around machine state, surfacing trip, fault, and service-due conditions above routine parameters, so an operator catches a failing compressor at first glance on hardware read through gloves on a loud, hot factory floor.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Mochitta • 0-to-1 Product Design (Capstone)

AUG 2025 – PRESENT

- Designed an emotion-aware personal-finance prototype (iOS) that asks how a purchase felt, then surfaces the patterns; validated across two moderated rounds, SUS rose **62.9 → 72.9** with all 12 benchmarks passing.

Black Baza Coffee • Product Designer (Freelance, 0-to-1)

JUN 2025 – SEP 2025

- Made sustainability a system, not a badge: a carbon calculator that shows its math and a store-pickup flow that lowers footprint, earning buyer **SUS 71.6** and 88% repeat-order success at a 65-second average.

SKILLS

Product Design

End-to-end UX, product thinking, information architecture, user flows, wireframes, prototyping, responsive UI, accessibility (WCAG)

Growth & Research

Usability testing, interviews, surveys, synthesis, KPI definition, event taxonomy, instrumentation

Tools

Figma, FigJam, Qualtrics, Maze, UserTesting, Dovetail, GA4, Amplitude, Mixpanel, Jira, Adobe Creative Suite

EDUCATION

MS, Human-Centered Design and Engineering

University of Michigan–Dearborn
• GPA 3.8

AUG 2024 – APR 2026

BS, Mechanical Engineering

Nagarjuna College of Engineering and Technology • GPA 3.7

MAY 2014 – MAY 2018

AWARDS & COMMUNITY

Extra Mile Award, Ingersoll Rand (Feb 2024)

Outstanding Spot Award, Ingersoll Rand (Jun 2023)

Design Club at UM–Dearborn, President: grew participation 70% and delivered 12+ design assets for campus partners